

Cyber Lab Setup Guide

VMware Workstation 17 Pro + Kali Linux

1. Download & Install VMware Workstation 17 Pro (Windows/Linux host)

- Go to **broadcom.com** -> click **Support Portal** (top right).
- Click **Register** to create a free Basic Broadcom account (or log in if you have one).
- Once logged in, make sure you're on **support.broadcom.com** and select the **VMware Cloud Foundation** division from the dropdown.
- In the left menu, click **My Downloads**.
- Search for "**VMware Workstation Pro**" in the search bar.
- Select the latest version (17.6.x, or the newer 25H2 naming) -> choose the **Personal Use** edition for your OS (Windows/Linux).
- Accept the Terms & Conditions, fill the short compliance form if prompted, then click **Download**.
- Run the installer (**.exe** on Windows) -> Next -> Accept license -> Next -> Install.
- On first launch, select the **Personal Use License** option (no key required) instead of entering a license key.

Direct portal link: <https://support.broadcom.com> -> My Downloads -> "VMware Workstation Pro"

2. Download Kali Linux

Kali Linux offers a pre-built VMware image this is faster and less error-prone than a manual ISO install.

- Go to **kali.org/get-kali**.
- Select the "**Virtual Machines**" tab (not Installer/Live).
- Choose **VMware** as the platform.
- Download the **Kali-Linux-VMware-Amd64 .7z** package (a few GB).
- Extract the **.7z** archive (7-Zip on Windows, or **7z x file.7z** on Linux) — gives a folder with a **.vmx** file and disk files.

Direct link: <https://www.kali.org/get-kali/#kali-virtual-machines>

3. Import Kali into VMware Workstation

- Open VMware Workstation Pro -> **File** -> **Open**.
- Browse to the extracted Kali folder -> select the **.vmx** file -> Open.
- Click "**I Copied It**" if prompted (keeps a fresh virtual MAC/UUID).
- Right-click the VM -> **Settings** -> minimum **4 GB RAM** / 2 vCPU (8 GB+ recommended for multiple VMs).
- Power on -> default credentials are **kali / kali** (change the password immediately).
- Update the system: **sudo apt update && sudo apt full-upgrade -y**.